

TEXAS TECH UNIVERSITY™

REPORT ON CUSTOMER SERVICE

For the Fiscal Years 2012-2013

TEXAS TECH UNIVERSITY

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I. Introduction

Texas Tech University is the largest institution of the Texas Tech University System. As a public research university, Texas Tech advances knowledge through innovative and creative teaching, research, and scholarship. The university is "dedicated to student success by preparing learners to be ethical leaders with multicultural and global competencies. The university is committed to educating a diverse and globally competitive workforce and enhancing the cultural and economic development of the state, nation, and world."[1]

The university is the comprehensive research institution of higher education in a region larger than 46 of the nation's 50 states. Texas Tech is a university with more than 1,500 faculty members; more than 32,000 students hailing from 249 counties in Texas, 50 states, and more than 116 countries around the world; and high-quality academic program offerings at the undergraduate (106), master's (102), and doctoral (55 including the J.D.) levels.[2]

Texas Tech University is located in Lubbock and operates educational sites in numerous Texas cities which include: El Paso, Fredericksburg, Junction, Marble Falls, and Waco. International educational centers are located in Seville, Spain, and Quedlinburg, Germany. Texas Tech strives to provide excellent quality education, research, and service in an environment that is caring and friendly to all its constituents including students, faculty, staff, administration, alumni, parents, and members of the greater community.

The university is a component of the Texas Tech University System (TTUS). The Texas Tech University System is comprised of the following: the System Administration (TTUSA); Texas Tech University (TTU); Texas Tech University Health Sciences Center (TTUHSC); and Angelo State University.

The size and diversity of the university require that the efforts for this report be focused to create an overall picture of the service climate at Texas Tech. As seen on the Inventory of Customers by Strategy Chart on page 2, the category of customers that is primarily impacted by the general appropriations funding is students.

The focus of this report is to summarize the information that is gathered at the institutional level. Two surveys are used on the institutional level to assess student satisfaction. The results reported in this document will reflect that the institutional perspective of the surveys used for this report is on students and the services provided around their educational experience.

The information for improvement plans in this report is a sampling from the annual assessment reports provided by departments and divisions of the university. Over 168 individual departments submit assessment reports which are summarized in division assessment reports. This activity is an integral part of the university's ongoing strategic planning and assessment cycle. All reports are posted on the Strategic Planning and Assessment Web site at: http://techdata.irs.ttu.edu/stratreport/index.asp.

[1] Texas Tech University Mission Statement adopted by the Board of Regents in May, 2010
[2] Excerpt from *Texas Tech University, FY 2011-2012 Fact Book*

II. Inventory of Customers by Strategy

A. Texas Tech University

Goal/Strategy	Customer
A. Goal: Instruction/Operations Provide Instruction and Operations Support	
A1.1 Strategy: Operations Support	students
A1.2 Strategy: Teaching Experience Supplement	students
A1.3 Strategy: Staff Group Insurance Premiums	staff/faculty
A1.4 Strategy: Worker's Compensation Insurance	staff/faculty/students
A1.5 Strategy: Texas Public Education Grants	students
A1.6 Strategy: Organized Activities	students
B. Goal: Infrastructure Support	
B1.1 Strategy: E&G Space Support	Students/faculty/staff
B1.2 Strategy: Tuition Revenue Bond Retirement	n/a
C. Goal: Special Item Support	
C1.1 Strategy: Library Archival Support	Students/public
C2.1 Strategy: Agricultural Research: Research to Enhance Ag Production & Add Value to Ag Products in Texas.	agribusiness
C2.2 Strategy: Energy Research: Energy Research in Energy and Environmental Protection in Texas.	citizens of Texas
C2.3 Strategy: Emerging Technologies Research: Research in Emerging Technologies and Economic Development in Texas.	agribusiness/communities/businesses/citizens of Texas
C3.1 Strategy: Junction Annex Operation	students/state organizations, agencies, and societies/the local community
C3.2 Strategy: Hill Country Educational Network	students and citizens of south Texas and the "hill country"
C3.3 Strategy: Small Business Development Center	small businesses in a 95-county area
C3.4 Strategy: Museums & Centers: Museums and historic, cultural and educational centers	public/students
C3.5 Strategy: Center for Financial Responsibility	students and employers
C4.1 Strategy: Institutional Enhancement	students/faculty/staff
D. Goal Research and Development Fund	
D1.1 Strategy: Research and Development Fund	faculty
D2.1 Strategy: Competitive Knowledge Fund: Recruit and hire quality faculty to improve the undergraduate experience, accommodate expected enrollment increase, and enhance the graduate and research mission of the institution.	Faculty/students

III. Information Gathering Summary

Since the development of the University Strategic Plan, each division and college has increased efforts to assess student satisfaction. Each division and college of the university solicits feedback from students in a variety of ways. Student focus groups and advisory boards are used in several colleges to get student input into academic and service issues. Surveys are used to gather information in the classroom and at points of contact. Information is tabulated in a variety of ways and is used as input into the division/college/department individual improvement plans.

Two annual surveys are used at the institutional level to track student satisfaction. The results of these surveys are the primary input for this *Report on Customer Service*. The first, the *Graduating Student Survey*, is sent to all graduating seniors three times a year. This survey asks the students to rate and comment on their academic department with regards to courses, faculty, advising, and facilities. In addition, various student services are assessed. This survey has been in use since 1991.

The second survey, the *Currently Enrolled Student Survey,* is an evaluation by the entire student body in the fall semester. This questionnaire measures the service quality of departments and activities such as the student's academic department, advising, computer services, libraries, registration, financial aid, parking, etc. Eighteen major departments or operations are covered in the latest version of the survey. A variety of questions are asked regarding each unit to determine if it is easy to obtain service; if questions are answered accurately and problems solved quickly; if the staff is courteous, knowledgeable, and willing to go the extra mile to help; and if office hours are convenient. This survey was designed in the year 2000 with the *Compact with Texans* in mind and has undergone periodic updates. It was originally a sample survey, but since 2002 the entire student body has been surveyed each year. In 2005, the questionnaire was expanded with the common set of service measures increasing from eight questions to twelve. Three more items were added in 2006 to cover education, student life, and overall satisfaction. More recently, the survey has been revised in the areas of information technology and Internet-based services.

Survey response rates are lower now than in earlier years as students suffer *survey fatigue* from numerous on-campus and off-campus survey requests, and the standard methods for boosting participation have become cost prohibitive. The response for the Graduating Student Survey (GSS) is about 19% as compared to earlier surveys of around 25%. The last four Currently Enrolled Student Surveys (CESS) have had response rates of 8% or 10% as compared to the average of 16% in earlier surveys. Continuous surveying over many years, large counts of survey returns, and surveying everyone (not a sample) makes the surveys a useful resource even at lower response rates. Represented in this report are the opinions of 1,471 graduating students and 5,756 current students. For the GSS, the margin of error at the 95% confidence level is typically plus or minus 0.07 to 0.09 on a 5-point scale for a general question applicable to most students. In the CESS, a question of the survey would typically have a very reliable average score plus or minus 0.05 or 0.06 points.

All surveys are now administered over the Internet. The results are tabulated by commercial survey-administration software and the resulting databases are audited for consistency and accuracy. Response rates are adversely affected by students not checking their e-mail, junk-mail filtering errors, and any network or Internet availability issues.

IV. Customer Satisfaction Survey Results

A. Institutional Surveys

In the *Graduating Student Survey*, graduating seniors answered the questions listed below that are particularly related to the issue of service. Table 1 gives the total percentage of students who rated the service as a "4" or a "5", the highest two ratings on the 5-point scale.

Table 1: Graduating Student Survey Results

Percentage of respondents well satisfied (rating of 4 or higher) regarding.	**2010**	**2011**
1. Faculty availability and helpfulness	79.9%	78.9%
2. Academic department staff helpfulness	69.4%	69.2%
3. Advisor Availability	63.3%	66.0%
4. Usefulness and accuracy of advisor information	59.9%	57.7%
5. Availability of study facilities	65.1%	65.3%
6. Library user assistance	66.2%	64.2%
7. Library hours of operation	83.6%	84.5%
8. Availability of computer labs	62.2%	60.9%
9. Assistance in computer labs	62.2%	60.1%
10. Student disability services*	**	79.2%
11. International student services***	**	**

*Ratings by small numbers of users of these specialized services.
** Too few responses from sub-sets of the main population for reporting.
*** Ratings by international students only.
(The data is for a calendar year of May, August, and December commencements.)

In the *Currently Enrolled Student Survey*, students are questioned regarding the service performance of selected departments. A dozen questions or more evaluate most units. Table 2 gives the percentage of high-level responses (4- or 5-value responses) for all questions in each of the departments or areas listed.

Table 2: Currently Enrolled Student Survey Results

Percentage of respondents well satisfied (rating of 4 or higher) regarding.	2010	2011
1. Academic department (12 questions)	82.0%	85.4%
2. Academic advising (12 questions)	81.9%	85.0%
3. Libraries (12 questions)	81.5%	83.7%
4. Student computing (12 questions)	67.6%	70.7%
5. Registrar (12 questions)	74.8%	80.6%
6. Student business services (12 questions)	60.6%	65.9%
7. Financial aid (15 questions)	56.8%	59.6%
8. Academic assistance & tutoring (12 questions)*	78.7%	79.2%
9. Parking services (12 questions)	62.9%	64.4%
10. Web services & Information Technology **	67.7%	70.1%

* Represented are only the relatively small numbers of students who use this specialized service.
**Covers on-line registration, the My Tech website, I.T. services, the TTU website, academic department websites, and Raiderlink using 41 questions. A section on personal technology helps to assess future needs.

V. Analysis of Findings and Improvement Plans

A. Analysis of Findings

Graduating Student Surveys

The latest data shows that students are quite satisfied with the university. In the three *Graduating Student Surveys* covering 2010, 23,264 ratings were received regarding 52 standard rating questions using a rating scale of 1 to 5 (poor to excellent), and for the 2011 surveys there were 35,363 ratings. In both years 84% of the ratings were of the top three ratings (*satisfactory* and higher). For comparison, in the first year, 2000, the percentage was a good but slightly lower 78%.

Using an even higher standard of excellence, 65% of the ratings in 2010 earned the top two ratings of “good” (4) or “excellent” (5), and in 2011, 63% were as high. These numbers too are higher than in year 2000 (55%).

In 2010 and 2011, only 6.5% and 6.3% of all ratings were in the lowest “poor” or “1” category.

Comparing the averages of nine major units in the oldest 2000-01 period to this report for 2010-11, the percentage of the respondents giving the two best scores increased an average of 6.3 percentage points per unit. Three units improved 9 or 10 percentage points.

Numerous comments are useful in putting the numbers into context by showing exactly what performance earns the high ratings and what does not.

Currently Enrolled Student Surveys

In the latest *Currently Enrolled Student Surveys*, the university continues to earn praiseworthy ratings. In 2010, 70.6% of the scores were *good* or *excellent*, and 73.3% of the scores were highly regarded in 2011. The top *three* scores account for 89.4% and 90.9% of the ratings in the latest two surveys.

Most services started with high ratings in 2000-01 and they have continued to do well with only small variations from year to year. While scores have never been low, on average, the units covered in the latest survey have proportions of high scores 8.5 percentage points greater than their low score. The departments having the lowest initial ratings (Financial Aid and Parking Services) have enjoyed better-than-average improvement.

Three new general questions introduced for the 2006-07 report rate (a) education, (b) college life, and (c) the total experience at Texas Tech. In the latest survey, at least 95% of the ratings for the new questions were the top 3 ratings. At a higher standard, those giving only a *4* or *5* score, the results are outstanding.

Comment opportunities throughout the survey attract thousands of remarks (over 15,000 comments in 2010 alone). These are useful in interpreting the numeric results as to what specifically needs improvement and which services, faculty, and staff are especially meritorious.

B. Improvement Plans

Annually, all areas of the university are required to assess and report the progress in achieving their goals and the results are posted on the university's strategic plan website.[3] The improvement plans reported here reflect a sampling of new initiatives and departments that are making a concerted effort to improve their services to high volumes of students.

1. Support Operations for Academic Retention (SOAR)

- In 2011, the number of tutoring contacts within the SOAR Learning Center increased from 5404 to 7960. This is a 47% increase from the previous year. The 7960 contacts accounted for 9670 contact hours.
- In 2011, audio/visual use within the SOAR Learning Center increased from 3805 to 5289. This is a 39% increase from the previous year. The 5289 contacts accounted for 8976 contact hours.
- In 2011, computer lab usage within the SOAR Learning Center increased from 1047 to 1084. This is a 4% increase from the previous semester. The 1084 contacts accounted for 774 contact hours.
- In 2011, the number of Licensed Professional Counseling and Learning Strategist contacts increased from 145 to 292. This is a 101% increase from the previous year. The 292 contacts accounted for 304 contact hours.

[3] Texas Tech University 2011 Strategic Plan Report

2. Student Financial Aid Initiatives

The following activities were accomplished in the 2011-2012 academic year:

- Launch of new Student Financial Aid website for concise delivery of information to students and parents.
- New liaison position for Student Financial Aid and Student Business Services fully utilized in coordination of Student Financial Aid procedures and processes, as well as billing account resolution and supervisory role in the call center.
- Successful loan comparison added to Student Financial Aid website for student and parents to compare terms and interest rates prior to borrowing.
- Continue a highly successful practice of staffing Senior Financial Aid Advisor in Law School.
- Continue to successfully utilize position with the responsibility to review and award TEXAS Grants and Texas B-On-Time loans to eligible students.
- Continue to realign loan processing for ease of student process completion, as well as workload process.
- Developed forms for student verification and special circumstances, including working forms for advisors to file in student's imaged documents; for consistency in audit and processing.
- Continue to address federal loan default rates, borrower concerns, and student loan indebtedness.

3. University Parking Services Initiatives

Increased Parking Space Availability

- In 2011, University Parking Services added 181 parking spaces to the University student parking inventory for a current total of 12,213 parking spaces. This increase, in addition to future planned student parking expansions, will prepare the department to handle the parking demand as the University's student population grows. University Parking Services added 423 parking spaces to the University faculty/staff parking inventory for a current total of 6,211. These additional parking spaces have allowed University Parking Services to provide parking for Strategic Hires and their appropriate support staff, as well as support non-academic departmental moves on campus that have created additional research space

Motorist Assistance Program

- University Parking Services provides a free Car Clinic three times a year; prior to Spring Break, late August and prior to the Thanksgiving Holidays. UPS partners with Scott's Complete Car Care to provide a routine inspection of the engine, tires and fluid levels, offering advice on road worthiness of vehicle, and recommendations on repairs prior to travel. The Car Clinic is available to the public. During the Car Clinic, UPS partners with various campus department and local agencies to promote safe driving habits. Of the 765 individuals who participated in the three Car Clinics, 16 were non-TTU attendees. University

Parking Services partners with the Marine Corps Toys for Tots. Students, Faculty/Staff and Community members may bring in a new toy, and UPS will dismiss a citation that is equal to or less than the value of the toy. Last year 104 toys were donated to Toys for Tots. University Parking Services offers a Motorist Assist Program. The Motorist Assist Program is available free of charge to any vehicle stranded on the Texas Tech campus. Services provided include vehicle unlock, free gallon of gas, air for a flat tire, as well as a boost for a dead battery. University Parking Services provided 1,319 assists during 2011, 102 of which were provided to non-TTU participants.

License Plate Recognition Project

- In 2011, University Parking Services implemented additional License Plate Recognition technologies to maximize personnel and operational resources and to reduce redundant printing expenses. University Parking Services was able to eliminate physical parking permits with the implementation of License Plate Recognition, realizing a cost savings of $60,000 per year. The License Plate Recognition allowed University Parking Services to maximize personnel resources. Utilizing vehicle-mounted cameras, in constant communication with License Plate Recognition software, University Parking Services employees are able to more efficiently enforce the campus parking system. This increased efficiency will allow University Parking Services to provide consistent levels of service for a growing campus population without an increase in staffing.

4. Student Disability Services

- In Fall 2011, 1398 students registered with Student Disability Services. The overall SDS GPA was 2.77%. In the fall of 2006 when the department implemented our student retention program, the overall SDS student GPA was 1.896%.
- Junior students showed great improvement with their GPA raising from 2.58% in Fall 2010 to 2.68% in Fall 2011. First year students continued to show success under our retention program with a Fall 2011 GPA of 2.53%.
- Spring 2011 semester the overall SDS GPA was 2.74%. Fall 2011 for students in the TECHniques Center program the cumulative GPA was 2.70%. The retention rate to Texas Tech University for students enrolled in the TECHniques Center program for Fall 2011 was 95%.
- The TECHniques Center program increased its enrollment capacity for the Fall 2011 semester to a cap of 180 students.
- Contacted all first-year students regarding their mid-term grades, use of accommodations, and any support services needed during their first and second semester at TTU. Additionally, all students who requested Letters of Accommodation for the semester and did not pick them up were contacted three times throughout the semester. The result of these efforts was that only 18 students failed to pick up their requested LOAs for Fall 2011.
- During Spring 2011 SDS provided conversion of 106 text books into electronic format for 34 students. During Fall 2011 SDS provided conversion of 197 text books into electronic format for 50 students.

- For Spring 2011 Sign Language Interpreters/Remote CART provided 2,763 hours of service for students. For Fall 2011 Sign Language Interpreters/Remote CART provided 2,723 hours of service for students.

5. Student Legal Services

- In 2011, over 95% of students reported that the assistance they received from SLS helped them better understand the legal process. 70% of SLS clients reported significant to expert knowledge regarding their legal issue after consultation with an SLS attorney; as compared to only 7% reporting significant to expert knowledge regarding their legal issue prior to consultation. 78.8% of students reported that the services provided by SLS enhanced their ability to focus on their studies. SLS assisted in the retention of over 471 students. Over 75% of students reported that the assistance they received from SLS positively impacted their ability to remain enrolled at Texas Tech University, and more than 50% indicated that SLS significantly impacted retention. Provided training opportunities to TTU Law School students and SLS employed 3 TTU law school students in FY11 (*Based upon FY11 SLS assessment data of 641 clients.)

VI. Customer Related Performance Measures

A. Outcome Measures:

Table 4: Overall Satisfaction Ratings

	Graduating Students			Current Students		
	2010	2011	2012 Target	2010	2011	2012 Target
% surveyed with a rating of 3 or higher	84.1%	84.0%	85%	89.4%	90.9%	91.5%
% surveyed with a rating of 4 or higher	64.8%	63.3%	64.8%	70.6%	73.3%	74.5%
% describing ways of improvement via comments*	79.4%	76.7%	79.4%	99 %	99%	99%

* The percentage is based on the number of individuals providing comments divided by the total number of students responding. Comments on specific topics in the Graduating Student Survey are optional, and they may also write about anything they like at the end of the survey. Thus, the number of comments will tend to vary according to what issues are especially noteworthy on the day the respondent completes the survey. (The surveys may be open for participation six weeks or more.) For the CESS, the survey requires comments on some questions, but not every response is a serious and relevant remark (hence the 99% instead of 100%).

B. Outcome Measures: Compact with Texans Service Areas

In the *Currently Enrolled Student Survey*, the same service-quality questions are repeated as appropriate for just about every department or function. Table 5 gives the total responses for each service characteristic throughout the survey.

Since 2005 (when the CESS was expanded to 12 common questions), the average for all such questions has improved from 3.85 to 4.01. The proportion of positive scores has improved from 72% in 2005 to 76% in 2011. The negative scores have always been low (9% or less), but for 2011 they accounted for a mere 7% of the ratings. The ratio of positive scores to negative ones had always been 8-to-1 or better. In 2011, there was a record high 10.5-to-1 ratio.

Table 5: Currently Enrolled Student Survey Response Averages

	2010 No. Resp.	2010 Avg. All	2011 No. Resp.	2011 Avg. All	Target 2012 Avg. All
My questions were answered	9,960	3.96	12,276	4.04	4.2
My problems were solved	9,960	3.88	12,276	3.98	4.1
Making contact was easy	9,960	3.95	12,276	3.97	4.1
Staff was courteous	9,960	4.03	12,276	4.12	4.2
Staff was knowledgeable	9,960	3.92	12,276	4.07	4.2
Staff was willing to go the extra mile	9,960	3.75	12,276	3.81	4.0
Response time was reasonable	9,960	3.90	12,276	3.99	4.2
Quality of the information was good	9,960	3.90	12,276	4.00	4.2
Hours of operation were convenient	9,960	4.03	12,276	4.06	4.2
Staff were responsive to requests	9,960	3.97	12,276	4.08	4.2
Staff were helpful	9,960	3.99	12,276	4.05	4.2
Online sources were useful	9,960	3.82	12,276	3.92	4.1

Note: The Internet survey software enforces a mandatory response. Hence, the counts are all the same for a given year.

C. Output Measures

	Graduating Seniors		Currently Enrolled Students	
	2010	2011	2010	2011
Number of customers surveyed	4,478	4,606	31,637	32,327
Number of customers served	4,478	4,606	31,637	32,327

Note: Graduating students are surveyed year-round, and the counts of customers served are from a table of degrees conferred by year. The goal is to have every graduating student or current student participate in these surveys. Repeated invitations are sent to improve contact and response rates. However, for each population the number surveyed is not precisely known since there are probably a small number of individuals who do not monitor their email, and there could be isolated technical problems beyond our knowledge.

D. Efficiency Measures: Cost per Customer Surveyed

Texas Tech University has been administering student opinion surveys since the 1980s. The department of Institutional Research has experience in surveys of prospective students, current students, former students, graduating students, alumni, faculty, and staff. Current databases contain a quarter of a million survey records. No additional personnel or resources were required to obtain the necessary survey data and complete portions of this *Report on Customer Service.* The cost per customer surveyed for this report is indistinguishable from pre-existing costs of operation.